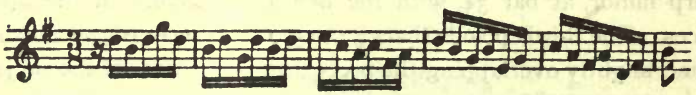
subject is in the treble, in the tonic key, slightly modified at its commencement, the triple counterpoint being found in bar 56. Bars 57 to 60 and 63 to 66 contain the fourth and fifth episodes, with new treatment of the semiquaver figure. In bars 60 to 63 the answer in the bass, and in bars 66 to 69 the subject again in the treble. Three of the six possible positions of triple counterpoint are employed, each theme appearing once in the bass; bar 56 should be carefully compared with bars 61 to 62 and bar 68.

FUGUE 39 (Book II, 15)

G MAJOR (THREE VOICES).

A fugue of simple construction, requiring little comment.

Exposition.—The subject is announced in the treble—



and is separated from the answer by a codetta of two bars, likewise in semiquavers, though with the arpeggios replaced by scale-passages. The answer is in the alto, and is **tonal**; it would also have been possible here to give a real answer, starting on supertonic, as the initial dominant is a note of small value, and part of an arpeggio. There is no regular countersubject. After a second codetta, similarly constructed to the first, the bass introduces the subject in bar 15. Bars 20 to 23 form a codetta to the exposition, making a cadence in the dominant key.

Middle Section.—There are two episodes (bars 23 to 33 and 45 to 64). They are both derived from the first notes of the subject. In the first, the treatment is by imitation at the interval of the

Ebenezer Prout: Analysis of J. S. Bach's Forty-Eight Fugues
Ed. Louis B. Prout. London: Edwin Ashdown, 1910. Printed pp. 74-75.
BWV 884. Complete original pages; adjoining commentary is retained.
Full source scan

fourth; the second episode is largely sequential. The latter closes with a long dominant pedal (bars 56 to 64). There is only one middle entry of the subject, namely, in the bass from bar 33.

Final Section.—This likewise contains only a single entry of the subject, which is given to the alto. A couple of bars are added to lead to the final perfect cadence.

A peculiarity of this fugue is the extensive compass of the upper voice, which from bar 60 to 63 goes down nearly to the lowest note of the bass. The flow of the parts shows clearly that it is the upper voice which descends here.

FUGUE 40 (Book II, 16)

G MINOR (FOUR VOICES).

One of the finest fugues in the whole collection, the countersubject being inverted in the tenth and twelfth as well as in the octave.

Exposition.—The subject, which is in the tenor, reaches to the second beat of bar 5:—



The answer, in the alto, commences with the final note of the subject, and is **tonal.** The countersubject follows the subject immediately, and terminates either at the first or second beat of bar 9, but its ending is usually altered after the exposition. There are no codettas, and the entries of the remaining voices are quite regular. The reappearance of the subject in the tenor at bar 20 in the original key, is best regarded as a redundant entry, although